

Tiffany Mao

PRODUCT DESIGNER

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Engineer-brained Product Designer focused on play, community, and entertainment. Full-stack design background spanning consumer apps, educational games, and physical interfaces.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Freelance Product Designer

Aug 2024 – Present · Remote

- Led 0–1 product design for a pre-seed AI startup, building the branding, design system, and full MVP flow from scratch.
- Rebuilt a software studio's website with dark/light mode support and redesigned the pricing page, turning a broken conversion flow into a functional one.
- Redesigned the explore page for a YC-backed no-code game mod creation platform, improving discoverability through SEO-informed information architecture and community browsing patterns for players and creators.

Design Engineer / Cocoon

Apr 2023 – Jun 2024 · San Francisco

- Owned UX for pregnancy disability leave features across 3 core flows, from user interviews and legal alignment to shipping production React components, serving 50+ companies.
- Built Cocoon's first design system, establishing a shared component library of 20+ components used by 15 engineers across a team of 6.
- Drove alignment across design, engineering, legal, and operations through stakeholder interviews and design reviews, managing sign-off across 3 departments from kickoff to launch.
- Led the first brand refresh, establishing visual consistency and ADA compliance across all user touchpoints.

Software Engineer / Meta

Sep 2022 – Nov 2022 · Menlo Park

- Applied user-centered design principles to revamp Android UI components for Facebook's video sharing team, improving visual accessibility across size and color.
- Designed and built React components for an internal pipeline tool, reducing friction from user error in a high-volume engineering workflow.
- Audited and improved Figma plugin graphics for color and text accessibility, ensuring WCAG compliance.

iOS Software Engineer Intern / Meta

Jun 2021 – Aug 2021 · Remote

- Shipped cross-posting components for Facebook and Instagram Stories, delivering a design-accurate eligibility page to millions of users.

PROJECTS

The Wonder Workshop

UC Berkeley x Common Sense Media · Jan – Mar 2025

- Co-designed a cozy educational crafting game for ages 9–11 with a team of 4 designers, built around a zero-failure-state model that keeps children engaged through intrinsic motivation rather than punishment mechanics.
- Collaboratively developed 3 critter companions, lesson structures, and core game mechanics to teach color, texture, and form through play.
- Designed a scrapbook and order-book mechanic that scaffolds creative confidence without prescribing correct answers.

PalBits — Customizable Game Controller

UC Berkeley · Sep 2025

- Designed a modular handheld controller for children ages 8–12 enabling in-game character evolution through swappable physical components.
- Synthesized industrial design, hardware integration, and game mechanics into a cohesive experience balancing self-expression with usability.

SKILLS

Design	Visual Design, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Front-End Development
User Experience	Wireframing, Prototyping, Accessibility, User Research, Usability Testing
Tools	Figma, Adobe CC, Procreate, Framer, HTML/CSS, Javascript, p5.js, Claude

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Expected Dec 2026

Master of Design (MDes)

University of California, Berkeley

2022

Bachelor of Arts, Computer Science